

BECOMING ORTHODOX

A Journey to the Ancient Christian Faith — Fr. Peter E. Gillquist



THE PILGRIMAGE — THREE MOVEMENTS



MOVEMENT I

SEARCH

Recognize what's missing

- Ch 1 Never Say Never
- Ch 2 The Phantom Search
- Ch 3 A Week We Will Not Forget
- Ch 4 Finding the New Testament Church



MOVEMENT II

DISCOVER

Test every objection against the sources

- Ch 5 The T Word — Tradition
- Ch 6 Why We Worship the Way We Do
- Ch 7 Call No Man Father
- Ch 8 Facing Up to Mary
- Ch 9 A Sign for All Christians



MOVEMENT III

ENTER

Walk into the historic Church

- Ch 10 A Decade of Decision
- Ch 11 Welcome Home
- Ch 12 On to the Third Millennium
- Epil. Coming Up on 25 Years

THE ARC OF THE JOURNEY

WHERE YOU START

- Privatized faith — Christ without church
- Worship as performance or preference
- Bible without the Church that wrote it
- Restless, fragmented, searching



WHERE YOU ARRIVE

- Christ-and-Church inseparable
- Worship as participation in heaven's liturgy
- Bible read in the voice of the Church
- At rest, rooted, on mission

"We were searching for the New Testament Church — soon to find that countless others were looking for the same."

— Fr. Peter Gillquist, Chapter 2

THE GET-ME-THERE ACTION CARD

A practical playbook in three phases — print and keep handy

I SEARCH

Recognize what's missing

1. Audit the gap.

Where is your current Christian life thin? Worship, sacrament, continuity, authority?

2. Reject false halves.

Christ-without-church and church-without-Christ both fail. Refuse both.

3. Stop chasing novelty.

The cure for restlessness is not the next new thing — it's the oldest thing.

4. Listen to the hunger.

Longing for beauty, sacrament, the saints — that's the Spirit calling you home.

5. Be willing to look foreign.

The original Church will look ancient. That's a feature, not a bug.

II DISCOVER

Test against the sources

1. Read the earliest sources.

Justin Martyr, Hippolytus, Didache, Ignatius. Don't take a modern's word for it.

2. Study the seven councils.

Nicaea to Nicaea II (AD 325–787). The doctrinal fence around the apostolic faith.

3. Sort tradition into two piles.

Tradition of men (condemned). Tradition of God (commanded). Late additions are not the latter.

4. Re-read the Bible liturgically.

In the voice of the Church that wrote and gathered it. Try the Orthodox Study Bible.

5. Address each big objection.

Tradition. Worship. "Father." Mary. The Cross. One at a time, honestly.

6. Commit in advance to change.

Without that commitment, study is self-justification. With it, it's conversion.

III ENTER

Take the step home

1. Visit a parish.

Don't audit Orthodoxy from afar. Walk in. Stay for the whole liturgy. Eat after.

2. Engage culture humbly.

Foreignness is part of the gift. Learn the people before you critique the culture.

3. Find a spiritual father.

A priest who will know you, walk with you, hear confession, correct, bless.

4. Submit to the rhythms.

Daily prayer with icons. The fasting cycle. Weekly liturgy. Frequent communion.

5. Receive chrismation.

When your priest agrees you're ready. Then you are home — and the journey begins.

6. Become missional.

You are not received to keep the secret. You are received to share it.

"Children, come home to the faith of your fathers, to your roots in Christendom."